migrations). Flyway keeps track of which migrations have already been applied through a `flyway_schema_history` table automatically created in the database the first time it runs. You can picture migrations as commits in a Git repository and the schema history table as the repository log containing the list of all the commits applied over time (figure 5.6).

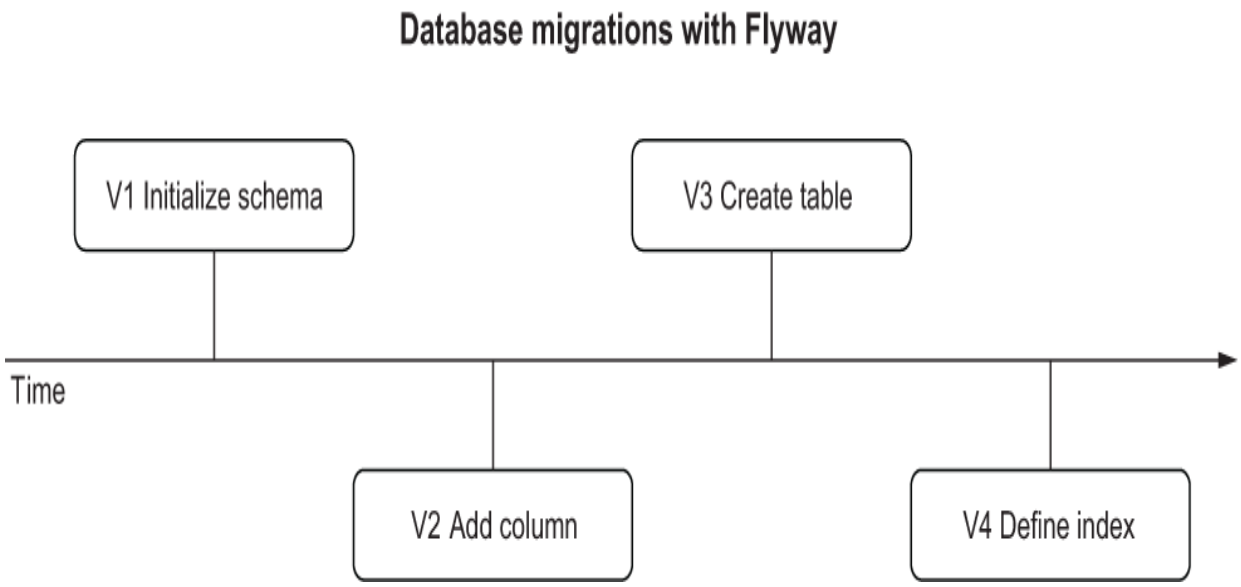


Figure 5.6 Flyway migrations represent database changes that can be pictured as commits in a Git repository.

NOTE A prerequisite for using Flyway is that both the database you want to manage and a user with the correct access privileges exist. Once you have a database and a user, Flyway can manage database changes for you. You shouldn't use Flyway to manage users.

You can use Flyway in standalone mode or embedded in a Java application. Spring Boot provides auto-configuration for it, making it very convenient to include Flyway in your applications. When integrated with Spring Boot, Flyway will search for SQL migrations in the src/main/resources/db/migration folder and Java migrations in src/main/java/db/migration.